David P. Adams

CURRICULUM VITAE

Division of Politics, Administration, and Justice
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Education

Ph.D., Public Policy and Public Administration, Auburn University, May 2016.

M.P.A., Public Administration, Auburn University, May 2010.

B.S., Political Science and Government, Kennesaw State University, May 2008.

Academic and Professional Appointments

Associate Chair and MPA Director, Division of Politics, Administration, and Justice, California State University, Fullerton, 2024–Present.

Associate Professor of Public Administration (with Tenure), Division of Politics, Administration, and Justice, California State University, Fullerton, 2022–Present.

Assistant Professor of Public Administration, Division of Politics, Administration, and Justice, California State University, Fullerton, 2016–2022.

Adjunct Professor, Department of Political Science, Auburn University, Summer 2016.

Research

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Journal Articles

Reill, Karen, and David P. Adams. 2026. “Fostering Equity, Engagement, Ethics, and Empathy in Public Service: A Narrative Vignette Study of City Managers.” *Public Integrity*, May, 1–15.

Naher, Nurun, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, Adam P. Mayer, John C. Morris, and Joseph A. Aistrup. 2026. “Inspector-Level Bureaucracy: Drilling into Discretion in a State Natural Resource Agency.” *Environmental Policy and Governance*, 36(1), 135–148.

McKnight, Steven P., David P. Adams, and Jonathan M. Fisk. 2026. “Does Disclosure Matter? Coupling Information to Performance in Texas.” *Policy Studies Journal*, 54(3).

Arthur, Prince, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, Matthew G. Jarvis, and Christopher A. Simon. 2025. "Exploring the Role of Multi-Agency Coordination in California's Climate Investment Program 2015–2024." *Public Organization Review*, 25, 1861–1878.

Adams, David P. 2025. "The Code Is the Policy: Blockchain Governance and the Authoritarian Pursuit of Administrative Efficiency." *Administrative Theory & Praxis*, 48, 17–27.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, and Adam P. Mayer. 2025. "Administrative Resilience Under Pressure: Environmental Governance and Institutional Adaptation." *Administrative Theory & Praxis*, 47, 289–295.

Amin, Alisha, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, and Adam P. Mayer. 2025. "Plugged In? Assessing the Distribution of Orphaned Wells." *Journal of Environmental Policy & Planning*, 27, 496–509.

Mahafza, Zachary, Jonathan M. Fisk, and David P. Adams. 2021. "Crude Contempt: Examining Local Pushback to Oil and Gas Development in California." *Politics & Policy*, 49(2), 479–501.

Adams, David P., Meriem Doucette, and Justin Tucker. 2019. "Affluence, Risk, and Community Engagement: The Case of Ascon and Huntington Beach." *California Journal of Politics and Policy*, 11(3), 1–19.

Books

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, and John Morris. *Navigating Water Quality Outcomes in American Watersheds*. May 2026, Cambridge University Press.

Books Under Contract

Naher, Nurun, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, and John C. Morris. *Governing Fossil Fuel Legacies: Policy Risk and Resistance*. Under contract with Routledge.

Fisk, Jonathan M., John C. Morris, David P. Adams, and Sean McKelvie. *Big Challenges in Water Policy: The Changing Face of Federalism*. Under contract with University of Utah Press.

Non-Peer-Reviewed Publications

Magazine Articles

Jarvis, Matthew G., David P. Adams, and Amir Dabirian. 2026. "Who Welcomes the Data Center? Infrastructure Siting, Community Capacity, and the Limits of NIMBY Politics." *IT Professional*, 28(5), 88–94.

Public Scholarship

Adams, David P. 2026. "The Code Coup: Blockchain Bureaucracy and the Quiet War on Discretion." *PA TIMES Online*, American Society for Public Administration, February 6, 2026.

Edited Textbooks

Doucette, Meriem, and David P. Adams, eds. 2019. *Ethics in Public Administration: Ethics, Corruption, and Public Policy*. San Diego, CA: Cognella.

Textbook Chapters

Adams, David P. 2019. "Minnesota Environmental Policy." In *Minnesota Government and Politics*, edited by James B. Cottrill, Shawn E. Schooley, Steven C. Wagner, and Shoua S. Yang. Dubuque, IA: Great River Learning Publishers.

Manuscripts Under Review

Adams, David P., Alissa Ackerman, Shelly Arsneault, Elaine Frey, and Brian Lovato. "Unseeing Like a State: Legibility, Burden, and Erasure of Queer Identities." Under review at *Administrative Theory & Praxis*.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, John C. Morris, and Karen Reill. "Working Together? The Legitimacy Halo Effect and the Ethics of Collaborative Watershed Governance." Under review at *Public Administration Review*.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, Kris Hartley, Farzana Zinnat, Jeremy Thomson, and Kiley Ryan. "Public Opposition to Data Centers: A Narrative Policy Framework Analysis of Tucson's Project Blue." Under review at *Review of Policy Research*.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, Matthew G. Jarvis, and Steven McKnight. "Disclosure and Enforcement in Fossil Fuel Extraction: Regional Impacts of Texas's Oil and Gas Transparency Reform." Under review at *The Extractive Industries and Society*.

Fisk, Jonathan M., David P. Adams, Craig Anderson, and Kris Hartley. "The Commons and Polycentricity: The Case of Data Centers in Utah." Under review at *Public Administration Review*, Practically Speaking.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, and John C. Morris. "Does Collaboration Deliver? Water Quality Outcomes in Watershed Governance." Revise and resubmit, *Society & Natural Resources*.

Manuscripts in Preparation

Adams, David P., Meriem Doucette, and Jonathan M. Fisk. *Contingent Leadership: Navigating the Tensions of Public Service Leadership*. Book proposal submitted to Routledge at the press's invitation, September 2026.

Adams, David P., Alisha Amin, Daniel del Barrio Alvarez, Jonathan M. Fisk, Kris Hartley, Antti Mäenpää, and Ayyoob Sharifi (listed alphabetically). *Data Center Dilemmas: Systems, Resources, and Policies*. Book proposal and first chapter submitted to the University of Utah Press, October 2026.

Naher, Nurun, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, Binita Mahato, and Alisha Amin. "When the Mission Changes: The Divergent Effects of Reform in Oil and Gas Compliance." In revision for *American Review of Public Administration*.

Adams, David P., and Jonathan M. Fisk. "Spill Patterns: Integrating Social Equity and Intergenerational Ethics in Colorado's Oil and Gas Policy Context." In preparation; presented in earlier form as "Reflections on Equity and the Politics of Energy Transitions" (with Ryan P. Scott) at the Elevating Ethics in the Public and Nonprofit Sectors Conference, Brigham Young University, 2026.

Refereed Presentations

Scott, Ryan P., David P. Adams, and Jonathan M. Fisk. 2026. "Reflections on Equity and the Politics of Energy Transitions." Presented at the Elevating Ethics in the Public and Nonprofit Sectors Conference, Brigham Young University, Provo, UT.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, and John C. Morris. 2026. "Working Together? Linking Trust, Ethics, and Performance in Watershed Governance." Paper presented at the Elevating Ethics in the Public and Nonprofit Sectors Conference, Brigham Young University, Provo, UT.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, Matthew G. Jarvis, and Steven McKnight. 2026. "Borderlands Governance and Regulatory Enforcement: Disclosure Reform and Enforcement Timing in Texas Oil and Gas Districts, 2015–2025." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Hollywood, CA.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, Matthew G. Jarvis, and Steven McKnight. 2026. "Returning to the Disclosure–Performance Link: Assessing Disclosure's Regional Impacts in Texas." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Hollywood, CA.

Naher, Nurun, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, Binita Mahato, and Alisha Amin. 2026. "When the Mission Changes: The Divergent Effects of Reform in Oil and Gas Compliance." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Hollywood, CA.

Chen, Xi, David P. Adams, and Jonathan M. Fisk. 2026. "Organizational Capacity and Goal Clarity in Oil and Gas Regulation: The Case of Texas." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Hollywood, CA.

Arthur, Prince, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, Matthew G. Jarvis, and Christopher A. Simon. 2026. "Exploring the Role of Multi-Agency Coordination in California's Climate Investment Program, 2015–2024." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Hollywood, CA.

Amin, Alisha, David P. Adams, Jonathan M. Fisk, Binita Mahato, and Nurun Naher. 2025. "Linking Disclosure to Performance: Assessing Colorado's 2021 Spill Reporting Rule and Operator Performance." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Washington, D.C.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, and John C. Morris. 2024. "Navigating Water Quality Outcomes in American Watersheds." Paper presented at the annual conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Minneapolis, MN.

Adams, David P., Nurun Naher, Jonathan M. Fisk, Adam P. Mayer, and John C. Morris. 2024. "Inspector-Level Bureaucracy: Drilling into Discretion in a State Natural Resource Agency." Paper presented at the national conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Minneapolis, MN.

Adams, David P., Jonathan M. Fisk, and Steven McKnight. 2024. "Does Disclosure Matter? Coupling Information to Performance in Texas." Paper presented at the national conference of the American Society for Public Administration, Minneapolis, MN.

Adams, David P., Alisha Amin, Jonathan M. Fisk, and Adam P. Mayer. 2024. “Plugged In? Assessing the Distribution of Orphaned Wells.” Paper presented at the annual conference of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.

Adams, David P., Zachary Mahafza, Jonathan M. Fisk, and Hanna Krawczyk. 2021. “Head for The Hills: An Environmental Justice Inquiry of Spills within Colorado’s Oil and Gas Industry.” Paper presented at the virtual national conference of the American Society for Public Administration.

Herrera, Veronica, David P. Adams, and Lidia E. Nuño. 2020. “American Indian Youth and Substance Use: Multilevel Analysis of School Related Factors.” Paper presented as part of the special event “Adolescence in the Context of Domestic and Global Diversity“ at the Society of Research on Adolescence (SRA) Biennial Meeting, San Diego, CA.

Adams, David P. and John Shipman. 2019. “Energy Efficiency Retrofits in Underserved Communities.” Paper presented at the International Symposium on Society and Natural Resource Management, Oshkosh, WI.

Adams, David P., Meriem Doucette, and Justin Tucker. 2018. “Affluence, Risk, and Community Engagement: The Case of Ascon and Huntington Beach.” Paper presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.

Adams, David P. 2015. “Central Network Importance for Collaborative Environmental Management.” Paper presented at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA.

Adams, David P. 2015. “Central Network Importance for Water Quality.” Paper presented at the International Symposium on Society and Resource Management Annual Meeting, Charleston, SC.

Adams, David P. 2014. “Environmental Outcomes of Local Watershed Information Networks.” Paper presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL.

Bowling, Cynthia, Kisha Hardwick, and David P. Adams. 2014. “Outstanding Programs and Potential Policy Diffusion Across the States.” Paper presented at the Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA.

Koehler, John, and David P. Adams. 2013. “Broadband Connections and Voter Turnout.” Paper presented at the Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL.

Hale, Kathleen, Mitchell Brown, and David P. Adams. 2012. “Enhancing Graduate Student Learning through Course Coordination and Integrated Assignments.” Paper presented at The Teaching and Learning Conference of the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Washington, D.C.

Hale, Kathleen, Mitchell Brown, and David P. Adams. 2012. “Enhancing Student Learning through Multi-Course Coordination and Learning Module Integration.” Paper presented at the Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA.

Adams, David P. 2010. “Constructing and Combating an Environmental Problem: Nonpoint Source Pollution in the Wolf Bay Watershed.” Poster presented at the Auburn University Department of Agriculture Economics and Rural Sociology Mobile Bay Watershed Project Annual Meeting, Auburn, AL.

Dissertation

Dissertation: "The Environmental Outcomes of Collaborative Natural Resource Institutions."

Committee: Kathleen Hale (Chair), Mitchell Brown (Co-chair), Gerry Gryski, Linda Dennard, and Elise Irwin.

Award: Auburn University Graduate School's Distinguished Dissertation Award

Teaching Experience

California State University, Fullerton

POSC 588: Collaborative Governance

POSC 315: Introduction to Public Policy

POSC 320: Introduction to Public Administration

POSC 509: Foundations of Public Administration

POSC 521: Capstone: Public Administration Theory

Auburn University

State and Local Government

Introduction to Public Administration

Research Methods I

Introduction to Political Theory

American Government

Policy Process

Courses Developed at California State University, Fullerton

POSC 428: Environmental Politics and Policy. Approved through Curriculog and now a permanent catalog course; first offered as POSC 415-T, Fall 2024.

POSC 316 / CPSC 316: AI Governance and Policy. Developed with the Department of Computer Science for its new artificial intelligence bachelor's degree and cross-listed; Curriculog, Fall 2026; first offering Fall 2028.

Grants, Honors, and Awards

Mellon Foundation New Directions Fellowship, nominated by California State University, Fullerton, 2025–2026 competition (not selected, March 2026).

California State University, Fullerton RSCA Intramural Grant, $15,000, 2025–2026.

California State University, Fullerton H&SS Dean's Research Award for Associate Professors, $2,500, Spring 2025.

Faculty Recognition for Service, Recognition of Outstanding Achievements in Service, California State University, Fullerton, December 2023.

California State University, Fullerton Office of Research and Sponsored Projects Summer Grant, $5,000, 2021.

California State University, Fullerton Faculty Advisor of Distinction Award, 2018.

Auburn University Graduate School Distinguished Dissertation Award, 2016.

Auburn University Department of Political Science PhD Student of the Year Award, 2016.

Auburn University College of Liberal Arts GTA Teaching Award, 2016.

SPSA Prestage-Cook Travel Award, 2014.

Omicron Delta Kappa Honor Society, 2013.

Delta Epsilon Iota Honor Society, 2013.

John and Elizabeth Morris Fund for Excellence Travel Grant, 2012.

Auburn University College of Liberal Arts Dissertation Research and Travel Grant, 2012.

Pi Sigma Alpha Honor Society, 2011.

Golden Key International Honour Society, 2010.

Best Performance Award for MPA Comprehensive Exam, 2010.

Pi Alpha Alpha Honor Society, 2009.

Professional Development

NASPAA Accreditation Institute, 2017, 2024

Data Analysis with Python Certification, FreeCodeCamp, 2021

Interuniversity Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR) Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research, University of Michigan, 2012

Teaching and Learning Conference of the American Political Science Association, Washington, D.C., 2012

Service

Service to the Public Administration Unit at California State University, Fullerton

Associate Chair and MPA Program Director, 2024–present

Interim PA Program Coordinator, Spring 2024

Chair, PS/PA Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee, 2023–2025

Member, PS/PA Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee, 2025–2026

MPA Program Admissions Coordinator, 2023–2025

PA Program Assessment Coordinator, 2017–present

MPA Program NASPAA Accreditation Liaison, 2017–present

MPA Program Faculty Advisor, 2024–2025

BAPA Program Faculty Advisor, 2023–2025

Advisor, Pi Alpha Alpha International Honor Society, 2023–present

Chair, PA Program Curriculum and Assessment Committee, 2026–2027

PA Program Curriculum and Assessment Committee, 2020–2022, 2024–2026

PA Program Awards Committee, 2018–present

Service to the Division of Politics, Administration, and Justice at California State University, Fullerton

Chair, Division Search Committee (Public Administration), Fall 2025

Chair, Division Peer Review Committee, 2025–2026

Chair, Division Personnel Committee, 2024–2025

Division Post Tenure Review Committee, 2024–2025

Executive Committee, 2018–2022, 2023–present

Division Personnel Committee, 2023–2024

Division Search Committee (Public Administration), 2023–2024

Division Peer Review Committee, 2022–2025

Advisor, Pi Sigma Alpha National Political Science Honor Society, 2023–2025

Division Awards Committee, 2018–2020, 2023–2024, 2025–2026

Division Commencement Committee, 2017–2018, 2024–2025

Division Curriculum Committee, 2020–2022, 2026–2027

Service to the Environmental Studies Program at California State University, Fullerton

Chair, Department Peer Review Committee, 2025–2026

Member, Department Peer Review Committee, 2026–2027

Service to the College of Humanities and Social Sciences at California State University, Fullerton

Chair, College Personnel Standards Review Committee (CPSRC), 2026–2027

Member, College Personnel Standards Review Committee (CPSRC), 2025–2026

Chair, Faculty Research and Grants Committee, 2026–2027

Member, Faculty Research and Grants Committee, 2023–2026

Service to the University at California State University, Fullerton

Social Sciences Representative, Academic Senate Academic Technology and Library Committee, 2025–2027

Social Sciences Representative, Academic Senate Graduate Education Committee, 2025–2028

Workshop Leader, Faculty Development Center, "From Syllabus to Canvas: Building Your Course Shell with an AI Agent," April and August 2026

Workshop Leader, Faculty Development Center, "Creating Accessible, CSUF-Compliant Syllabi in LaTeX," August 2025

Member, Academic Senate Assessment & Educational Effectiveness Committee, 2024–2025

Faculty Advisor, Tau Kappa Epsilon International Fraternity, 2017–2024

Member, G.E. Assessment Faculty Learning Community, 2019–2021

Faculty Advisor, United Nations Association–USA; Generation United Nations, 2017–2019

Service to the Profession

Conference Organizer, SENRA Symposium (Section on Environmental and Natural Resources Administration), American Society for Public Administration Annual Conference, Hollywood, CA, 2026; New Orleans, LA, 2027

Section Member, Section on Environmental and Natural Resources Administration (SENRA), American Society for Public Administration, 2020–present

Section Member, LGBTQ+ Public Administration, American Society for Public Administration, 2020–present

Section Member, Democracy and Social Justice, American Society for Public Administration, 2020–present

Manuscript Reviewer, *Administrative Theory & Praxis*, 2025–present

Manuscript Reviewer, *Perspectives on Public Management and Governance*, 2026

Manuscript Reviewer, *State and Local Government Review*, 2026

Manuscript Reviewer, *Social Science Quarterly*, 2026

Book Proposal Reviewer, Cambridge University Press, 2026

AP Reader, U.S. Government and Politics, College Board, 2026

Manuscript Reviewer, *Journal of Public and Nonprofit Affairs*, 2019–present

Manuscript Reviewer, *Journal of Political Science Education*, 2018–present

Panel Chair, Environment and Public Policy, Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2018

Panel Chair, Flirting with Disaster: Politics, the Environment & Public Policy, Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2017

Round Table Participant, Teaching: Graduate Education, Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2017

Deil Wright Best Paper in Federalism Award Reviewer, American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2016

Student Affairs Committee Member, International Society for Social and Natural Resources, 2013–2014

Discussant, Federalism and Intergovernmental Relations Panel, Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2013

Panelist, Assessment and Teaching Political Science Round Table, Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2012

Service to the Community

Designer and Builder, California Policy Data Dashboard Platform, Center for Public Policy, California State University, Fullerton, 2026

Invited Speaker, League of Women Voters of North Orange County, Fullerton, CA, March 27, 2025

Professional Memberships

American Society for Public Administration

International Society for Social and Natural Resources

Pi Sigma Alpha National Political Science Honor Society

Pi Alpha Alpha National Public Affairs and Administration Honor Society

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